

Inverse Trig

1. Find the exact value of each of the following:

- a. $\sin^{-1} 0$
- b. $\sin^{-1} \frac{1}{2}$
- c. $\cos^{-1} 1$
- d. $\tan^{-1} 1$
- e. $\sin^{-1}(-1)$
- f. $\cos^{-1} 0$
- g. $\tan^{-1} 0$
- h. $\tan^{-1}(-1)$
- i. $\sin^{-1}\left(-\frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}\right)$
- j. $\cos^{-1}\left(-\frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}\right)$
- k. $\tan^{-1}\left(-\frac{1}{\sqrt{3}}\right)$
- l. $\cos^{-1}(-1)$

2. Use your calculator to find, correct to three decimal places, the value of:

- a. $\cos^{-1} 0.123$
- b. $\cos^{-1}(-0.123)$
- c. $\sin^{-1} \frac{2}{3}$
- d. $\sin^{-1}\left(-\frac{2}{3}\right)$
- e. $\tan^{-1} 5$
- f. $\tan^{-1}(-5)$

3. Find the exact values of the following (if they exist).

- a. $\arcsin 1$
- b. $\arcsin 0$
- c. $\arcsin(-1)$
- d. $\arcsin \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}$
- e. $\arcsin\left(-\frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}\right)$
- f. $\arccos 1$
- g. $\arccos 0$
- h. $\arccos(-1)$
- i. $\arccos \frac{1}{2}$
- j. $\arccos\left(-\frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}\right)$
- k. $\arctan 1$
- l. $\arctan(-1)$
- m. $\tan^{-1} \sqrt{3}$
- n. $\tan^{-1}\left(-\frac{1}{\sqrt{3}}\right)$
- o. $\sin^{-1}\left(\sin \frac{\pi}{4}\right)$

- p. $\sin^{-1}(\sin 80^\circ)$
- q. $\sin^{-1}\left(\sin \frac{2\pi}{3}\right)$
- r. $\sin^{-1}\left(\sin\left(-\frac{3\pi}{4}\right)\right)$
- s. $\cos^{-1}\left(\cos \frac{\pi}{3}\right)$
- t. $\cos^{-1}\left(\cos \frac{2\pi}{3}\right)$
- u. $\cos^{-1}\left(\cos\left(-\frac{\pi}{3}\right)\right)$
- v. $\tan^{-1}\left(\tan \frac{7\pi}{6}\right)$

4. Find the exact value of

- a. $\sin^{-1}\left(-\frac{1}{2}\right) + \cos^{-1}\left(-\frac{1}{2}\right)$
- b. $\sin(\cos^{-1} 0)$
- c. $\tan(\tan^{-1} 1)$
- d. $\cos^{-1}\left(\sin \frac{\pi}{3}\right)$
- e. $\sin\left(\cos^{-1} \frac{1}{2}\sqrt{3}\right)$
- f. $\cos^{-1}\left(\cos \frac{3\pi}{4}\right)$
- g. $\tan^{-1}\left(-\tan \frac{\pi}{6}\right)$
- h. $\cos(2 \tan^{-1}(-1))$
- i. $\tan^{-1}\left(\sqrt{6} \sin \frac{\pi}{4}\right)$

5. Find the exact value of:

- a. $\sin^{-1}\left(\sin \frac{4\pi}{3}\right)$
- b. $\cos^{-1}\left(\cos\left(-\frac{\pi}{4}\right)\right)$
- c. $\tan^{-1}\left(\tan \frac{5\pi}{6}\right)$
- d. $\cos^{-1}\left(\cos \frac{5\pi}{4}\right)$
- e. $\sin^{-1}\left(2 \sin\left(-\frac{\pi}{6}\right)\right)$
- f. $\tan^{-1}\left(3 \tan \frac{7\pi}{6}\right)$

6. Evaluate the following

- a. $\cos\left(\sin^{-1} \frac{1}{2}\right)$
- b. $\tan\left(\tan^{-1}\left(-\frac{5}{13}\right)\right)$
- c. $\tan^{-1}(\tan 245^\circ)$
- d. $\cos^{-1}(\cos 540^\circ)$
- e. $\cos(\tan^{-1}(-\sqrt{3}))$
- f. $\cos\left(2 \sin^{-1} \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}\right)$
- g. $\cos\left(2 \cos^{-1} \frac{5}{13}\right)$
- h. $\sec\left(\sin^{-1}\left(-\frac{1}{3}\right)\right)$

7. a. In each part use a right-angled triangle within a quadrants diagram to help find the exact value of:

- $\sin\left(\cos^{-1}\frac{3}{5}\right)$
- $\tan\left(\sin^{-1}\frac{5}{13}\right)$
- $\cos\left(\sin^{-1}\frac{2}{3}\right)$
- $\sin\left(\cos^{-1}\left(-\frac{15}{17}\right)\right)$
- $\cos\left(\tan^{-1}\left(-\frac{1}{3}\right)\right)$
- $\tan\left(\cos^{-1}\left(-\frac{3}{4}\right)\right)$

- b. Use a right-angled triangle in each part to show that:

- $\sin(\cos^{-1} x) = \sqrt{1-x^2}$
- $\sin^{-1} x = \tan^{-1}\left(\frac{x}{\sqrt{1-x^2}}\right)$

8. Use an appropriate compound-angle formula and the techniques of the previous question where necessary to find the exact value of

- $\sin\left(\sin^{-1}\frac{4}{5} + \sin^{-1}\frac{12}{13}\right)$
- $\cos\left(\tan^{-1}\frac{1}{2} + \sin^{-1}\frac{1}{4}\right)$
- $\tan\left(\tan^{-1}\frac{1}{4} + \tan^{-1}\frac{3}{5}\right)$
- $\tan\left(\sin^{-1}\frac{3}{5} + \cos^{-1}\frac{12}{13}\right)$

9. Use an appropriate double-angle formula to find the exact value of

- $\cos\left(2\cos^{-1}\frac{1}{3}\right)$
- $\sin\left(2\cos^{-1}\frac{6}{7}\right)$
- $\tan(2\tan^{-1}(-2))$

10. a. If $\alpha = \tan^{-1}\frac{1}{2}$ and $\beta = \tan^{-1}\frac{1}{3}$, show that $\tan(\alpha + \beta) = 1$.

- b. Hence find the exact value of $\tan^{-1}\frac{1}{2} + \tan^{-1}\frac{1}{3}$.

11. Use a technique similar to that in the previous question to show that:

- $\sin^{-1}\frac{1}{\sqrt{5}} + \sin^{-1}\frac{1}{\sqrt{10}} = \frac{\pi}{4}$
- $\tan^{-1}\frac{1}{2} - \tan^{-1}\frac{1}{4} = \tan^{-1}\frac{2}{9}$
- $\cos^{-1}\frac{3}{11} - \sin^{-1}\frac{3}{4} = \sin^{-1}\frac{19}{44}$
- $\sin^{-1}\frac{1}{3} + \cos^{-1}\frac{1}{3} = \frac{\pi}{2}$

12. a. If $\theta = \sin^{-1}\frac{3}{5}$, show that $\cos 2\theta = \frac{7}{25}$.

- b. Hence show that $\cos^{-1}\frac{7}{25} = 2\sin^{-1}\frac{3}{5}$

13. Use techniques similar to that in the previous question to prove that

- $\tan^{-1}\frac{3}{4} = 2\tan^{-1}\frac{1}{3}$
- $2\cos^{-1}x = \cos^{-1}(2x^2 - 1)$, for $0 \leq x \leq 1$
- $2\tan^{-1}2 = \pi - \cos^{-1}\frac{3}{5}$

14. Show that:

- $\tan^{-1}4 - \tan^{-1}\frac{3}{5} = \frac{\pi}{4}$
- $\sin^{-1}\frac{3}{5} + \sin^{-1}\left(-\frac{3}{5}\right) = 0$
- $\tan^{-1}\frac{5}{12} + \cos^{-1}\frac{5}{13} = \frac{\pi}{2}$
- $\cos^{-1}\frac{3}{5} - \tan^{-1}\left(-\frac{3}{4}\right) = \frac{\pi}{2}$
- $2\sin^{-1}\frac{3}{5} = \sin^{-1}\frac{24}{25}$
- $\sin^{-1}\frac{3}{5} + \tan^{-1}\frac{7}{24} = \cos^{-1}\frac{3}{5}$
- $\sin^{-1}\frac{5}{13} + \tan^{-1}\frac{16}{63} = \cos^{-1}\frac{4}{5}$

15. Find the exact value of the following.

- $\sin\left[\sin^{-1}\left(\frac{3}{5}\right)\right] + \sin\left[\sin^{-1}\left(-\frac{3}{5}\right)\right]$
- $\sin\left[\sin^{-1}\frac{3}{5} + \sin^{-1}\left(-\frac{3}{5}\right)\right]$
- $\cos\left[\sin^{-1}\frac{5}{13} + \sin^{-1}\frac{4}{5}\right]$
- $\sin\left(2\tan^{-1}\frac{4}{3}\right)$
- $\cos\left[\tan^{-1}\frac{4}{3} - \cos^{-1}\frac{5}{13}\right]$
- $\sin\left[\cos^{-1}\frac{3}{5} + \tan^{-1}\left(-\frac{3}{4}\right)\right]$
- $\tan\left[\tan^{-1}\frac{4}{3} + \tan^{-1}\frac{12}{13}\right]$

16. Solve the following pairs of simultaneous equations.

- $2\sin^{-1}x + \cos^{-1}y = -\frac{\pi}{12}$,
 $\sin^{-1}x - 2\cos^{-1}y = -\frac{2\pi}{3}$
- $\sin^{-1}x + \cos^{-1}y = -\frac{\pi}{12}$, $\cos^{-1}x - \sin^{-1}y = \frac{5\pi}{12}$

17. a. Show that the $\sin(\sin^{-1}x - \cos^{-1}x) = 2x^2 - 1$ for $-1 \leq x \leq 1$.

- b. Show that if $-1 \leq x \leq 1$ then $-1 \leq 2x^2 - 1 \leq 1$.

- c. Hence solve $\sin^{-1}x - \cos^{-1}x = \sin^{-1}(5x - 4)$

18. Prove that $f(x) = \tan(\cos^{-1} x)$ is an odd function.
19. a. Explain why $\sin^{-1}(\sin 2) \neq 2$
 b. Sketch the curve $y = \sin x$ for $0 \leq x \leq \pi$, and use symmetry to explain why $\sin 2 = \sin(\pi - 2)$.
 c. What is the exact value of $\sin^{-1}(\sin 2)$?
20. Let x be a positive number and let $\theta = \tan^{-1} x$.
- a. Simplify $\tan\left(\frac{\pi}{2} - \theta\right)$.
 b. Show that $\tan^{-1} \frac{1}{x} = \frac{\pi}{2} - \theta$
 c. Hence show that $\tan^{-1} x + \tan^{-1} \frac{1}{x} = \frac{\pi}{2}$, for $x > 0$.
 d. Use that fact that $\tan^{-1} x$ is odd to find $\tan^{-1} x + \tan^{-1} \frac{1}{x}$, for $x < 0$.
21. a. If $\alpha = \tan^{-1} x$ and $\beta = \tan^{-1} 2x$, write down an expression for $\tan(\alpha + \beta)$ in terms of x .
 b. Hence solve the equation $\tan^{-1} x + \tan^{-1} 2x = \tan^{-1} 3$.
22. Using an approach similar to that in the previous question, solve for x :
 a. $\tan^{-1} x + \tan^{-1} 2 = \tan^{-1} 7$
 b. $\tan^{-1} 3x - \tan^{-1} x = \tan^{-1} \frac{1}{2}$
23. a. If $\alpha = \sin^{-1} x$, $\beta = \tan^{-1} x$ and $\alpha + \beta = \frac{\pi}{2}$, show that $\cos(\alpha + \beta) = \frac{\sqrt{1-x^2}-x^2}{\sqrt{1+x^2}}$
 b. Hence show that $x^2 = \frac{\sqrt{5}-1}{2}$.
24. a. If $u = \tan^{-1} \frac{1}{3}$ and $v = \tan^{-1} \frac{1}{5}$, show that $\tan(u + v) = \frac{4}{7}$.
 b. Show that $\tan^{-1} \frac{1}{3} + \tan^{-1} \frac{1}{5} + \tan^{-1} \frac{1}{7} + \tan^{-1} \frac{1}{8} = \frac{\pi}{4}$.
25. Show that $\tan^{-1} \frac{1}{2} + \tan^{-1} \frac{2}{5} + \tan^{-1} \frac{8}{9} = \frac{\pi}{2}$
26. Solve $\tan^{-1} \frac{x}{x+1} + \tan^{-1} \frac{x}{1-x} = \tan^{-1} \frac{6}{7}$.

Answer

1. a. 0; b. $\frac{\pi}{6}$; c. 0; d. $\frac{\pi}{4}$; e. $-\frac{\pi}{2}$; f. $\frac{\pi}{2}$; g. 0; h. $-\frac{\pi}{4}$; i. $-\frac{\pi}{3}$; j. $\frac{3\pi}{4}$; k. $-\frac{\pi}{6}$; l. π .
2. a. $\frac{\pi}{2}$; b. 0; c. $-\frac{\pi}{2}$; d. $\frac{\pi}{3}$; e. $-\frac{\pi}{3}$; f. 0; g. $\frac{\pi}{2}$; h. π ; i. $\frac{\pi}{3}$; j. $\frac{5\pi}{6}$; k. $\frac{\pi}{4}$; l. $-\frac{\pi}{4}$; m. $\frac{\pi}{3}$; n. $-\frac{\pi}{6}$; o. $\frac{\pi}{4}$; p. 80° ; q. $\frac{\pi}{3}$; r. $-\frac{\pi}{4}$; s. $\frac{\pi}{3}$; t. $\frac{2\pi}{3}$; u. $\frac{\pi}{3}$; v. $\frac{\pi}{6}$.
3. a. 1.447; b. 1.694; c. 0.730; d. -0.730; e. 1.373; f. -1.373
4. a. $\frac{\pi}{2}$; b. 1; c. 1; d. $\frac{\pi}{6}$; e. $\frac{1}{2}$; f. $\frac{3\pi}{4}$; g. $-\frac{\pi}{6}$; h. 0; i. $\frac{\pi}{3}$
5. a. $-\frac{\pi}{3}$; b. $\frac{\pi}{4}$; c. $-\frac{\pi}{6}$; d. $\frac{3\pi}{4}$; e. $-\frac{\pi}{2}$; f. $\frac{\pi}{3}$
6. a. $\frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}$; b. $-\frac{5}{13}$; c. 65° ; d. 180° ; e. $\frac{1}{2}$; f. $-\frac{1}{2}$; g. $-\frac{119}{169}$; h. $\frac{3\sqrt{2}}{4}$
7. a. i. $\frac{4}{5}$; ii. $\frac{5}{12}$; iii. $\frac{1}{3}\sqrt{5}$; iv. $\frac{8}{17}$; v. $\frac{3}{10}\sqrt{10}$; vi. $-\frac{1}{3}\sqrt{7}$
8. a. $\frac{56}{65}$; b. $\frac{10\sqrt{3}-\sqrt{5}}{20}$; c. 1; d. $\frac{56}{33}$
9. a. $-\frac{7}{9}$; b. $\frac{12}{49}\sqrt{13}$; c. $\frac{4}{3}$
10. b. $\frac{\pi}{4}$
15. a. 0; b. 0; c. $\frac{16}{65}$; d. $\frac{24}{25}$; e. $\frac{63}{65}$; f. $\frac{7}{25}$; g. $-\frac{88}{9}$
16. a. $x = -\frac{1}{2}$, $y = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}$; b. $x = -\frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}$, $y = \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}$
17. c. $x = 1$
19. a. 2 is outside the range of the inverse sine function, which is $-\frac{\pi}{2} \leq y \leq \frac{\pi}{2}$; b. It is because the sine curve is symmetrical about $x = \frac{\pi}{2}$; c. $\pi - 2$
20. a. $\cot \theta$; d. $-\frac{\pi}{2}$
21. a. $\frac{3x}{1-2x^2}$; b. $x = \frac{1}{2}$ (note that $x \neq 1$)
22. a. $x = \frac{1}{3}$; b. $x = \frac{1}{3}$ or 1
26. $x = -\frac{3}{2}$ or $\frac{1}{3}$